

THE GARAMUT



A MESSAGE SENDER

Ps Barry's *Reflections on:* **PRAYER,** **PROCLAMATION and** **PERSONAL PROGRESS**

Bethel Global Missions
No.51. 16th of December 2024



DOING WHAT IS RIGHT!

The Judge of all the earth does what is right.

Genesis 18:25 Far be it from you to do such a thing — to kill the righteous with the wicked, treating the righteous and the wicked alike. Far be it from you! **Will not the Judge of all the earth do right?** NIV

God does what is right.

Exodus 15:26 He said, "If you listen carefully to the voice of the Lord your **God and do what is right in his eyes,** NIV

David did what is right in God's eyes.

1 Kings 14:8 My servant David, who kept My commandments and who followed Me with all his heart, **to do only what was right in My eyes;** NKJV

God has led us in the right paths.

Proverbs 4:11 I have taught you in the way of wisdom; **I have led you in right paths.** NKJV

The Lord declares what is right and true.

Isaiah 45:19 I have not spoken in secret, from somewhere in a land of darkness; I have not said to Jacob's descendants, 'Seek me in vain.' I, the Lord, speak the truth; **I declare what is right.** NIV

The ways of the Lord are right.

Hosea 14:9 **The ways of the Lord are right;** the righteous walk in them, but the rebellious stumble in them. NIV

.....
Some say God will do nothing - neither good or bad

Zephaniah 1:12, ".....**who think, 'The Lord will do nothing, either good or bad.'** NIV

SOME IMPORTANT PRINCIPLES TO REMEMBER IN DOING WHAT IS RIGHT.

1. ALWAYS ENDEAVOUR TO DO GOOD.

- **In all circumstances do what is right.**

Galatians 6:10 As we have therefore opportunity, **let us do good unto all men,** especially unto them who are of the household of faith. KJV

Micah 6:8 He hath shewed thee, **O man, what is good; and what doth the Lord require of thee, but to do justly, and to love mercy, and to walk humbly with thy God?** KJV

Hebrews 13:16 **But to do good** and to communicate forget not: for with such sacrifices God is well pleased. KJV

1 Timothy 6:18 **That they do good,** that they be rich in good works, ready to distribute, willing to communicate: KJV

Luke 6:27 But I say unto you which hear, Love your enemies, **do good to them which hate you,** KJV

1 Peter 3:11 **He must turn from evil and do good;** he must seek peace and pursue it. NIV

2. EVIL WILL ALWAYS BE PRESENT WHEN YOU WANT TO DO GOOD.

Romans 7:21 So I find it to be a law that when I want to do right, evil lies close at hand. ESV

- **Be ready for that conflict within you. But always do good**

3. DOING WHAT IS RIGHT ALWAYS WINS THROUGH IN THE END but it must come from a sincere and committed heart.

- **THIS IS THE LESSON LEARNED FROM THE STORY OF KING AMAZIAH OF JUDEA IN 2 CHRONICLES 25:1-2**

2 Chronicles 25:1-2

1 Amaziah was twenty and five years old when he began to reign, and he reigned twenty and nine years in Jerusalem. And his mother's name was Jehoaddan of Jerusalem.

2 And he did that which was right in the sight of the Lord

- **But not with a perfect heart.** KJV

- **But sometimes resented it** TLB

- But not wholeheartedly NIV
- But not with a loyal heart NKJV
- But his heart was not **COMPLETELY** true to the Lord". BBE

■ **DOING WHAT IS RIGHT REQUIRES A PERFECT HEART- A LOYAL HEART, A WHOLE-HEARTEDNESS, (with ALL the heart)**

- It IS essential in serving God!

■ THE FOLLOWING SCRIPTURES GIVE A TOTAL SUMMARY OF HOW AMAZIAH DID WHAT WAS RIGHT BUT NOT PERFECTLY.

2 Chronicles 25:1-2

1 Amaziah was twenty and five years old when he began to reign, and he reigned twenty and nine years in Jerusalem. And his mother's name was Jehoaddan of Jerusalem.

- 2 Chronicles 25:2 And he did that which was right in the sight of the Lord, but not with a perfect heart. KJV
- 2 Chronicles 25:2 He did what was right in the eyes of the Lord, but not wholeheartedly. NIV
- 2 Chronicles 25:2 He did what the Lord approved, but not with wholehearted devotion. NET
- 2 Chronicles 25:2 He did what was right, but sometimes resented it! TLB
- 2 Chronicles 25:2 He did what was right in the eyes of the Lord, but his heart was not completely true to the Lord. BBE
- 2 Chronicles 25:2 He did what was pleasing to the Lord but did it reluctantly. GNT
- 2 Chronicles 25:2 Amaziah did what the Lord said was right, but he did not really want to obey him. NCV

■ **WHAT A DISAPPOINTING SUMMARY OF AMAZIAH'S ACCOUNT** OF DOING WHAT WAS RIGHT IN WHAT GOD REQUIRED – **BUT NOT WITH A TRUE HEART – HE DID RELUCTANTLY - HE RESENTED IT.**

- However, there are some people who might think that doing what is right is all that is required but HOW it is done is on equal importance. **IT SHOULD BE DONE WITH A WILLING AND SINCERE HEART.**

- **SO AMAZIAH'S EXAMPLE OF SERVING GOD IS NOT ONE THAT WE SHOULD FOLLOW.**

- **BECAUSE AMAZIAH DID GOOD BUT FOR THE WRONG REASONS.**

■ **AMAZIAH ACTED PRESUMPTUOUSLY, IMPROPERLY and this brought great trouble upon the nation.**

- He hired men from Israel to fight as mercenaries with Amaziah's Army instead of trusting in God.

2 Chronicles 25:5-6

5 Then Amaziah organized the army, assigning generals and captains for all Judah and Benjamin. He took a census and found that he had an army of 300,000 select troops, twenty years old and older, all trained in the use of spear and shield. 6 He also paid about 7,500 pounds of silver to hire 100,000 experienced fighting men from Israel. NLT
THEN THE MAN OF GOD CAME (the prophet) AND PROPHESED AGAINST AMAZIAH.

His message from God was:

- If you let these hired men from Israel join with your army, you will be defeated,
- And it doesn't matter how hard you fight you will be defeated for God will overthrow you,
- For he has power to help you or to trip you up.

2 Chronicles 25:7-8

7 But a man of God came to him and said, "Your Majesty, do not hire troops from Israel, for the Lord is not with Israel. He will not help those people of Ephraim! - 8 If you let them go with your troops into battle, you will be defeated by the enemy no matter how well you fight. God will overthrow you, for he has the power to help you or to trip you up." NLT

- This was a direct **REBUKE and WARNING** to Amaziah, that you have behaved wrongly.
- BUT, from another perspective it was also a **COMPASSIONATE word from a loving God who cared for Amaziah and what happened to him.**

■ **AMAZIAH'S RESPONSE**

- **It was about the money - 'but what about my money'?**
- **THAT WAS HIS FIRST THOUGHT.**
- **THERE WAS NO MENTION ABOUT HIM BEING SORRY TO GOD OR ACKNOWLEDGING THAT HE HAD ACTED HASTILY AND IMPROPERLY.**
- There was no expression of him being thankful to God for sending the prophet to warn him that he had done foolishly and saved him from certain destruction.
- There was nothing about these important things in the immediate response of Amaziah because his focus was only about the loss of his money, his 7,500 pounds of silver.

■ **THIS HIGHLIGHTS WHAT MONEY AND POSSESSIONS CAN DO TO A PERSON'S LIFE WHO HAS BEEN TAKEN CAPTIVE BY "THE LOVE OF MONEY".**

■ **LET US BE A PEOPLE WHO ARE KNOWN AS THOSE WHO DO WHAT IS RIGHT.**

Amen – Ps Barry